

be industry champions. Especially, as the factors that enable such a thing are coming together: with internet penetration and cheaper computers there would be 20-25 million broadband subscribers just as the mobiles are growing constantly.”

The growth story

IT industry body NASSCOM has projected the Indian animation industry to reach \$1.16 billion of revenues by 2012. The industry is currently worth \$460 million and is expected to grow at a CAGR (Compound Annual Growth Rate) of 27%.

Custom content development is the largest segment as of today, with an estimated industry size of \$187.5 million while animation education is slated to be the fastest growing. The report expects the gaming industry in India to reach \$1.06 billion of revenues by 2012 from its current \$212 million.

“The global animation and gaming industry has been growing at a CAGR of almost 8-10 % and this billion dollar industry has great scope of employment for those who are ready to try their skills in it. This industry has also been fairly recession resistant, if not recession proof and will continue to see demand over the next 3 years,” says Tapaas Chakravarti, CEO of DQE.

What are the related paths in this career that you can pursue?

- Programmers
- Artists
- Designers

The main thing is the intrinsic talent. Besides having a Bachelors' in Science, an Engineering in Computer Science with a background in Maths and Physics helps. Main knowledge is important and less stress on tools will do. All these three kind of profiles work together in a team.

Talent is the key, experience not as important.

What do you do in your studio?

Vitek Goyal, CEO Pixeltek: We work on 3D graphics and video game development, mainly catering to game developers. We help in outsourcing and streamlining. We are a small team of 12 people. Instead of the whole game, we do a part of it, like character and asset building.

How did you get into this field?

Vitek Goyal: I used to love playing video games. I mean since I was young. Then, I went on to get a degree in Interactive Arts from New York. At that time I was still a layman with no technical know-how. After I returned to India, I started reading articles doing research on game developing. After which I advertised in a paper and this was pretty much the road map of the company.

Why did you choose this career?

Vitek Goyal: We are always racing against crazy deadlines. And within that time to come up with results that are brilliant is quite a high.

With these unique highs come the benefit of seeing tangible results. It's rewarding to see your mention in the credits, to see your product on a shelf. To know that all the hard work you put into it has culminated into something that people would enjoy. This profession also gives you a chance to interact with people from abroad, meet different kind of mindsets, etc. It's worth it.

Face-2-Face with practitioner

“Do it. It's not for everyone. It sounds really good and fun, which it is, but also a lot of hard work. But if you love gaming, you'd enjoy it.”

Vitek Goyal
CEO of Pixeltek